MDI GURGAON · TERM IV

Business Storytelling Using Data

COMPLETE EXAM & QUIZ COMPANION

Concept Bank · Framework Glossary · Worked Narrations · 120+ Practice Questions with Answer Key

Compiled across all class sessions (Group Recaps 1–8) taught by
Prof. Vidhu Gaur

Prepared for Kishore Kunal · 38BM21

How to Use This Companion

This document consolidates the entire Business Storytelling Using Data course into one revision resource. It is built from the eight group session recaps and reorganised for exam preparation — so instead of hunting across eight decks, you revise from a single coherent narrative. It has five parts:

PART A	The Concept Bank — every framework, model, and idea from all sessions, session by session, in exam-ready form.
PART B	The Master Glossary — all mnemonics and acronyms (SAPA, SCARF, TRUST, 3Es, FOTE/POTE, Gestalt, Aristotle's 7, and more) on one revisable spread.
PART C	Worked Narrations — model spoken answers that show the frameworks in action, ready to adapt for a viva or a written 'craft a narrative' question.
PART D	The Question Bank — 120+ questions: MCQs, short-answer, match-the-framework, and application/case prompts, graded easy → hard.
PART E	Answer Key + Exam Strategy — full answers with the reasoning, plus how to attack each question type under time pressure.

> **Examiner's-eye view — what this course actually tests**
>
> This is not a numbers course. It tests whether you can (1) name and correctly apply a framework, (2) read an audience and adapt your delivery, and (3) diagnose a leadership/culture situation objectively before recommending action. Almost every question reduces to one of those three moves. Keep that lens as you revise.

Part A · The Concept Bank

Organised in teaching sequence. Each session block gives you the core idea, the framework in full, and the exam hooks — the specific points examiners lift questions from.

A1 · Why Narrative? The Business Case

Narrative requires both IQ and EQ

IQ — Intellectual Quotient	EQ — Emotional Quotient
Logic, data, evidence, structure. The rational spine of the argument.	Empathy, tone, human connection. What makes the argument land and stick.

> **The Death of a Salesman — the cautionary tale**
>
> Arthur Miller's **Willy Loman** had all the facts about his sales territory but **no narrative** — he could not connect emotionally with buyers. The lesson: a **poker face in your audience = disengagement.** No expression → not interested. True in every boardroom, pitch, and data presentation.

A2 · Know Your Audience — Three Layers

Before you speak, analyse the audience across three deepening layers. Demographics is the surface; psychographics is the layer that actually changes how you tell the story.

Layer	What it covers	Exam hook
1. Demographics	Age, income, education, gender, occupation.	Generational read: Gen X (1965–80) = hardworking, logic-driven → lead with numbers. Millennials (1981–99) = purpose-driven → start with 'why it matters.' Gen Z (2001–12) = short attention, need daily purpose reinforcement.
2. Socio-graphics	Place, region, topography, cultural belt.	Culture is CORE, not cosmetic. A narrative that works in Mumbai may fall flat in Chennai. Example: McKinsey India produces region-specific reports, not one monolith.
3. Psychographics	Personality/decision style: Directive, Spontaneous, Reflective, Cooperative.	The deepest layer — split the audience into 4 types and adapt narrative style to each (full table below). This is the single most testable idea in the audience unit.

The 4 Psychographic Audience Types — the money framework

Type	Drive	How to present + example
Directive	Quantify. Prove. Data-driven; logic and proof are currency.	Lead with the bottom line, ROI up front, charts and benchmarks. Ex: a CFO reviewing a budget wants numbers on slide 1, not the backstory.
Spontaneous	Inspire & energize. Child-like curiosity; bored by heavy data.	Vivid storytelling, analogies, drama, TED-talk energy. Ex: pitching a new product to a startup founder — lead with the vision and the 'wow', then the data.

Reflective	Show your homework. Wants depth; the hardest audience.	Demonstrate thorough prep — answer the 5 W's + How, never skip detail. Ex: a policy committee that reads every footnote and annex.
Cooperative	Earn trust first. Needs to feel heard; IQ matters less.	Listen more than you speak, ask questions, show humility, build rapport before data. Ex: a community consultation for a CSR initiative.

> **Memory hook**
> **D-S-R-C** → *"Directors Show Real Character."* Directive = data, Spontaneous = story, Reflective = research, Cooperative = rapport.

A3 · The 5 Skills of a Real-Time Narrator

Great narrators aren't born — they cultivate five skills that let them build a narrative live and adapt as the room changes.

Skill	What it is + anchoring example
1. Presence of Mind (POM)	Hold and process multiple threads at once — the room, the data, the reaction — without losing composure. Ex: Satya Nadella in town halls connects an employee concern to a business metric with empathy, live.
2. Spontaneity	Deviate from the script when the moment demands. Ex: Warren Buffett's unplanned anecdotes at Berkshire's AGM make the audience lean in — it feels real.
3. Alert / Vigilant	Constantly read the room — body language, energy, confusion — and adjust before people disengage. Ex: a consultant notices the CFO checking his watch and pivots to the cost slide immediately, not three slides later.
4. Listening Skills	Listening is active data collection, not passive. Ex: the best consultants speak ~30% and listen ~70% in discovery; the story they tell is shaped by what they heard.
5. Mindfulness	Stay present; prevent 'narrative drift' where you go on autopilot and lose the thread. Ex: meditation-trained execs (Aetna, Google, LinkedIn) report sharper narrative clarity in high-stakes talks.

A4 · Narrative Structure & the Pyramid Principle

The Narrative Arc (Group 5)

A repeatable sequence for building the body of any talk:

1. **To the Point** — open with the core message; don't bury the lead.
2. **Problem** — state the challenge so it is felt, not just understood.
3. **Bit of Logic** — data, evidence, proof. This is where your IQ shows.
4. **Bit of Emotion** — a story, example, or human moment. This is your EQ.
5. **Bit of Persuasion** — a clear call to action; what do you want them to decide?
6. **Drama / Style** — tone, pacing, hooks. The difference between forgettable and memorable.

The Pyramid Principle (Group 5 + Group 4)

Top: Recommendation / APEX	Lead with the takeaway — the single core message.
Middle: Reasons / Arguments	The supporting logic and grouped arguments (logic + data).
Base: Evidence	The data, facts, examples and detail that back everything up.

> **Golden rule of engagement**
>
> **Engagement → Purpose → Respect.** Always ask a question first, then build the story. And remember the Pyramid inverts the instinct of a nervous presenter: conclusion first, not conclusion last.

A5 · Crafting & Delivering a Story — the Group 4 Toolkit

This unit gives you six interlocking components. Learn them as a pipeline: mine → build → organise → deliver.

Core story elements

Hero	The story runs through the hero's own journey and experience — the audience sees through their eyes.
Transformation	A story is shaped to create hope or belief in the audience. Change is the point of telling it — no transformation, no story.

The Storyboard — mining personal material

A grid that maps your own life against career stages and themes, used to mine raw material for authentic stories. You plot life stages (childhood, B.E., MBA, family) against career/domain events (a startup failure, a personal connection) and recurring themes, then pull out usable 'story beats.'

The Story Blueprint — Origin / Choices / Environment

Origin	Where the story started.
Choices	The key decisions made along the way.
Environment	The context and conditions shaping it.

The Story Template — the four-beat 'Recipe'

The 6 components — how they fit together

Plot	Arc	Template	Structure
WHAT story you are telling.	Decides how the audience FEELS.	ORGANISES it.	HOW you tell it.
Storyboard	**Pyramid Principle**		
PLANS it.	DELIVERS it (top-down).		

One-line summary (high-yield)

A good business story isn't improvised: it is **mined** through the Storyboard, **built** on a Blueprint (Origin/Choices/Environment) and a Recipe (Situation→Problem→Solution→Input), and **delivered** top-down through the Pyramid Principle.

A6 · Structured Case Analysis — the SAPA Framework

> **The Narrative Rule (examiners love this)**
> When recounting events, stay **entirely objective** — never insert personal opinion into the narrative phase. You **evaluate, never judge.**

Step	What you do
S — Situation Analysis	Map the facts in clear, objective bullet points. No interpretation yet.
P — Problem Identification	Split into Long-Term problems (e.g. a trust deficit) and Short-Term problems (e.g. a bypass of authority).
A — Decision Analysis	Brainstorm ~5 alternatives; evaluate pros and cons objectively. Never judge, always evaluate.
A — Plan of Action	Rate the alternatives systematically and select the option that best applies the framework.

A7 · Leadership Styles — Skill vs. Will

Match your leadership behaviour to where an employee sits on two axes: Skill (capability) and Will (motivation). Four archetypes, four prescribed behaviours.

Archetype	Skill / Will	Prescribed behaviour
Newbies	Low Skill · High Will	High motivation, low baseline ability → High Task / High Relationship.
Superstars	High Skill · High Will	Highly autonomous → Low Task / Low Relationship. Hand them the keys.
P.P.P. (Pity Party Players)	Low Skill · Low Will	→ Autocratic 'Telling': High Task / Low Relationship.
Shipwrecks	High Skill · Low Will	Strong capability, low motivation → High Relationship / Low Task to re-engage.

Matching behaviour to the situation (the four styles)

Style	Task / Relationship	When to use
Telling	High Task / Low Relationship	Autocratic — low capability, low willingness.
Selling	High Task / High Relationship	Benevolent-autocratic — sells the rationale while directing.
Participating	High Relationship / Low Task	Democratic — shared decisions with capable, willing people.
Delegating	Low Relationship / Low Task	Hand-off — for highly skilled, self-motivated stars.

A8 · Managing Toxic Employees

7. **Communication** — understand root causes while giving open, transparent feedback.
8. **Action** — explain organizational impact clearly; maintain formal documentation of offenses.
9. **Task Orientation** — isolate where necessary and keep focus strictly on core work output.

The Data-Oriented Feedback Model

- **Be Direct** — ground the conversation in objective, data-oriented points.
- **Identify Specific Behaviors** — cite exact behaviors; document rigorously (e.g. minutes of meeting).
- **State the Impact** — explain exactly how the behavior affects the team or business.

> **THE GOLDEN RULE**
> **Never describe the person — only their actions and data.**

A9 · Visual & Data Principles — from Data to Story

The 6 Gestalt Principles of Visual Perception

Principle	What it means for a chart
Proximity	Objects close together are perceived as a group.
Similarity	Similar-looking elements are seen as having the same function.
Closure	The mind fills gaps to perceive a complete shape.
Continuity	Aligned elements in a line or curve feel more related.
Figure-Ground	The eye separates an object from its background.
Common Fate	Elements moving the same way are seen as one unit.

The 7 Structures of Data Presentation

Structure	Question it answers
Change over time	What changed from past to present?
Comparison	Who or what is better?
Ranking	Who is first, and who is last?
Distribution	How are things spread out?
Part-to-whole	What components make up the total?
Correlation	Are these variables connected?
Spatial	Where is this happening geographically?

Where it all gets used (strategic application)

- **Internal & external alignment** — help team members and channel partners understand complex dynamics.

- **Competitive positioning** — map your business clearly against competitors.
- **Personal narrative** — structure data and frameworks to answer 'Who are you?' professionally.

A10 · Building Trust Through Integrity

Trust is the foundation of storytelling and leadership. It is built where three things meet: Integrity, Competence (capability), and consistent Results.

Pillar	Component	Detail
Intent	**FOTE / POTE**	FOTE = Fully Open Truthful Exchange (complete transparency, strongest trust). POTE = Partially Open Truthful Exchange (selective disclosure while staying honest).
Capability	**Competence + 5 Markers**	Trust depends on demonstrated ability, not just good intent. The 5 markers: Talent, Attitude, Skill, Knowledge, and Style.
Results	**Track Record + Timeline**	Consistent performance reinforces credibility over time — proven across Past, Present, and Future performance.

> **Key takeaway**
> Trust is built when **integrity, competence, and consistent results** come together.

A11 · The 3Es of Effective Storytelling

A simple framework for capturing and holding an audience.

E	Principle	Tools / cues
Engagement	Capture attention within the first seven seconds.	Story · Question · Statistic · Quote · Image · Prop · Video.
Essence	Focus on one clear message; avoid unnecessary complexity.	One core idea · no clutter · clarity first.
Energy	Delivery influences impact as much as content.	Eye contact · voice modulation · body language · manage nerves.

A12 · Aristotle's Seven Elements of Storytelling

Great business presentations combine logic with emotional storytelling. Learn each element with its direct business application.

Element	Meaning	Business application
Theme	The central idea to remember.	Focus the deck on one central message.
Plot	Logical flow of events.	Maintain a logical, sequential narrative.
Character	People who create emotional connection.	Humanize the data behind the numbers.
Dialogue	Communication that drives the story.	Encourage interaction and discussion.
Decor	Context and setting.	Understand the audience and business context.
Melody	Emotional rhythm.	Build emotional resonance with stakeholders.
Spectacle	Unexpected moments that keep attention.	Present surprising, attention-grabbing insights.

A13 · Creating a Vocal Culture & Balanced Leadership

Vocal culture

Open communication compounds into stronger organizational performance. It has a culture side and a function side.

Culture (the norms)	Function (the practice)
Include feedback · be straightforward · be informal.	Choose participants wisely · show proactive concern · share results.

Balanced leadership (the People × Task grid)

Plot leadership style on two axes — concern for People and concern for Tasks — yielding four positions.

Relationship-Oriented — motivation, communication, team development.	**Balanced Leadership — combines empathy with execution successfully.**
Low Engagement — limited focus on people and tasks alike.	Task-Oriented — prioritizes goals, efficiency, and execution.

> **Key takeaway**
> **Great leaders balance empathy with execution.**

A14 · Leadership vs. Authority — the PSU Case

The cast and their styles

Person / Role	Leadership signature
Rajshekhar — Unit COM	Results-driven, low tolerance for excuses; favoured shortcuts over rigid process compliance.
Naresh — Senior Manager	“Gandhiji of Pipelines” — conflict-averse and humane, but quietly bypassed formal hierarchy.
Bala — Manager	Disengaged 'messenger' leadership — delegated upward via avoidance, took no ownership.
Ilengo — Civil Engineer	Technically capable junior who became the informal fix for a structural gap.

Root causes of the conflict

10. An informal workaround masked a structural gap — Naresh engaging Ilengo directly compensated for Bala's disengagement but built no lasting capability into Bala's role.
11. Simultaneous transfers removed the 'cushion' — with no transition or accountability plan, the gap was exposed abruptly.
12. The leadership response felt punitive — relocation plus withdrawal of staff escalated a performance issue into a grievance.

Culture, accountability & the decision

- **Embedded inefficiency** — obsolete systems and informal fixes had become 'normal,' leaving no process to reabsorb a disengaged manager's role.

- **Bystander silence** — colleagues took a 'diplomatic stand,' isolating Rajshekhar and leaving the inquiry without context.
- **Decision without due process** — a unilateral, emotion-driven correction was ruled 'irrational and too hard,' damaging Rajshekhar's authority far more than the original lapse.

> **Corporate parallel — Wells Fargo**
>
> The Wells Fargo account-opening scandal followed the same pattern: informal workarounds became embedded practice, oversight was bypassed by 'diplomatic silence,' and correction came only after external escalation — once reputational damage exceeded the operational cost.

The five executive takeaways (PSU case)

13. **Authority enforces; leadership aligns** — secure commitment before issuing directives, especially on role changes.
14. **Build accountability into roles, not relationships** — informal workarounds are operational debt that compounds.
15. **Separate performance issues from disciplinary action** — to preserve fairness and procedural defensibility.
16. **Treat structural transfers as change events** — requiring a transition plan, not administrative reshuffles.
17. **Presence is a credibility multiplier** — composed posture, full eye contact, and a controlled voice make sound decisions land as legitimate.

A15 · Executive Presence — the Physical Vocabulary of Authority

Non-verbal signals shape how a decision is received — the same message reads as confident or defensive depending on delivery.

Channel	What to do
Posture & sitting	Sit back, use the full seat, feet grounded; avoid the 'Figure of Four' leg-cross — signals composure, not arrogance or anxiety.
Gestures	Hands move in sync with speech, then return to rest — purposeful, not fidgety.
Eye contact	Engage the whole room, not just visibly agreeable listeners — builds inclusive credibility.
Voice modulation	Project clearly and command the room; volume signals conviction without aggression.
Narrative building	For short talks (under 15 minutes) hold your position and let the speaker — not the slides — anchor attention.

The through-line of the whole course

Leadership effectiveness is ultimately a communication outcome: the soundest decision fails without the presence and narrative to carry it — and the weakest decision survives longer than it should when delivered with composure and clarity.

A16 · Narrative Weaving — the 8 Steps

Eight steps to craft a story that lands. Steps 1–4 are construction; steps 5–8 are delivery mechanics.

Step	What it does	Anchor example
1. Right word, right time — Rule of 3	Repeat 3 words sharing the same initial sound for rhythm and recall (alliteration).	MLK: '…let freedom ring.' Churchill: 'Blood, toil, tears and sweat.'
2. Hook statement	Open with a line that creates instant curiosity or tension.	Steve Jobs, 2007: 'Today, Apple reinvents the phone.'
3. Amplify connection	Tie the story to a shared value or lived experience of the listener.	Satya Nadella opens with his son's story to humanize Microsoft's mission.
4. Superb engagement	Use questions, pauses, and visuals to keep the audience leaning in.	TED speakers average a rhetorical question every ~90 seconds.
5. Intonation modulation	Vary pitch and pace to signal emphasis and emotion.	Oprah slows down and lowers pitch at her most vulnerable lines.
6. Closure	End by resolving the tension you opened with — circle back to the hook.	Jobs closed the iPhone launch by replaying 'reinvents the phone.'
7. Body language	Posture, gestures, and eye contact reinforce credibility and warmth.	Obama's open-palm gestures signal honesty and invite trust.
8. No fillers	Cut 'um,' 'like,' 'basically' — silence reads as confidence.	Toastmasters' 'Ah-Counter' role exists solely to police filler words.

A17 · Audience Archetypes — Reading a CEO

Five archetypes of decision-makers, each needing a different persuasion strategy, vocabulary, and proof style.

Archetype	Strategy	Buzzwords + example CEOs
Charismatic	Paint a bold future state; appeal to emotion and legacy before logic.	'Game-changing,' 'transform,' 'legacy,' 'bet big.' Ex: Herb Kelleher.
Thinker	Lead with data, frameworks, ROI; let the numbers carry the argument.	'ROI,' 'data shows,' 'benchmark,' 'efficiency.' Ex: Bill Gates, Satya Nadella. Wants the model before the metaphor.
Skeptic	Lead with proof points, pilots, third-party validation; address objections first.	'Proven,' 'de-risked,' 'validated,' 'track record.' Ex: Elon Musk, Larry Ellison. Assumes risk until proven otherwise.
Follower	Show social proof and what peers/competitors are already doing.	'Industry standard,' 'everyone's moving to,' 'best practice.' Moves with the herd, not ahead of it.
Controller	Give granular control, clear milestones, accountability checkpoints.	'Compliance,' 'governance,' 'accountability,' 'oversight.' Ex: Jeff Bezos, Steve Jobs. Needs to own the process, not just the outcome.

A18 · The SCARF Model — the Neuroscience of Response

Domain	Definition	Workplace example
S — Status	Relative importance to others.	Public credit in meetings; titles and promotions raise status.
C — Certainty	Ability to predict the future.	Clear project roadmaps reduce anxiety vs. vague timelines.
A — Autonomy	Sense of control over events.	Letting a team choose its own sprint approach boosts buy-in.
R — Relatedness	Sense of safety with others; friend or foe.	Onboarding buddies and team intros build trust fast.
F — Fairness	Perception of fair exchanges.	Transparent pay bands and even-handed feedback reduce resentment.

Applying SCARF to Narrative — reduce the threat, increase the reward

Element	How to apply it in storytelling	Model line you can say
Status	Don't try to look smarter — make the audience feel knowledgeable and capable. Appreciate their expertise.	“Given your experience in operations, you'll immediately recognize this challenge.”
Certainty	Give a clear roadmap up front — state what you'll cover and how long it takes.	“In the next five minutes I'll cover the problem, the solution, and the expected business impact.”
Autonomy	Present options instead of dictating one answer — let the audience feel they own the decision.	“There are three implementation paths. Option B looks strongest, but the choice depends on your priorities.”
Relatedness	Build rapport through shared experience, empathy, and common goals.	“We've all been on projects where deadlines slipped because ownership was unclear.”
Fairness	Present both benefits and risks — no exaggeration, no one-sided pitch.	“This strategy reduces cost, but it also raises implementation complexity in the first quarter.”

The phrasing shift — poor vs. better

Each SCARF domain has a default 'threat' phrasing most presenters reach for, and a 'reward' rewrite. Learning the pairs is the fastest way to make this usable under exam pressure.

Domain	Threat phrasing (avoid)	Reward phrasing (use)
Status	“Let me explain this because it's quite complicated.”	“Given your background you know the broader challenge — let me focus on the part that's most relevant.”
Certainty	Diving straight into detail with no signposting.	“We'll answer three questions: What's the problem? Why does it matter? What's the solution?”
Autonomy	“You should implement this.”	“Here are three alternatives; based on your objectives, Option A gives the best balance of cost and impact.”

Relatedness	Opening cold with data and no human anchor.	"We've all sat through meetings where no one was sure who owned the next step."
Fairness	Selling only the upside.	"This improves speed but may require higher upfront investment."

Worked walkthrough — SCARF across one product-strategy pitch

The five domains aren't separate slides; they're threaded through a single talk. Here is the same product-strategy pitch hitting all five in sequence:

> **Status →** "Your experience in this industry gives valuable context to this discussion."
>
> **Certainty →** "I'll cover the market, our recommendation, and the implementation plan in ten minutes."
>
> **Autonomy →** "We've evaluated three strategic options; I'll explain the trade-offs so you can decide which fits your objectives."
>
> **Relatedness →** "Many organizations face this exact challenge during digital transformation."
>
> **Fairness →** "Although Option B offers the highest ROI, it also carries greater implementation risk."

The five self-check questions (memorise these)

While presenting, run the audience's brain through this checklist. If you can answer 'yes' to all five, you have de-risked the room.

Domain	Ask yourself while presenting
Status	Am I making the audience feel respected, rather than trying to impress them?
Certainty	Have I clearly explained where this presentation is going?
Autonomy	Am I giving the audience ownership and meaningful choices?
Relatedness	Have I created a genuine human connection?
Fairness	Am I presenting a balanced, transparent viewpoint?

> **Exam framing for SCARF**
>
> If a question asks you to 'apply SCARF' to a talk or a difficult conversation, don't just define the five words — for each one, name the **threat you're removing** and the **reward you're adding**, then give a concrete line. That threat/reward pairing is what separates a top-band answer from a definition dump.

A20 · The TRUST Framework & Building a Counter-Narrative

Component	Tag	Meaning
Integrity	TWAB in sync	Thoughts, Words, Actions, Behavior all aligned.
Intent	Agenda / Motive	A clear, declared agenda and motivation.
FOTE	Full Open Truthful Exchange	Transparency in all communications.
Capability	T-A-S-K	Talent, Attitude, Skills, Knowledge.
Results	Timeline	Past, Present and Future performance.

A21 · Workplace Conduct — Spectrum, Risk Factors & the Boundary Case

The Juhi & Reddy case

Juhi, a new engineer (4–5 years' experience), joins the team. Reddy, a senior colleague, tries to be comforting but becomes overly intrusive and violates personal boundaries. Key point for exams: even protective intentions become harmful once they cross a boundary — Reddy, as the older senior, was expected to maintain professional distance. The lesson is 'Respect Boundaries: protective behavior can become intrusive.'

The Spectrum of Sexual Misconduct at Work (SSMW) — six levels

Level	Description
1. Generally Not Offensive	Lowest degree; non-harmful comments (e.g. appearance remarks).
2. Awkward / Mildly Offensive	Underlying gender-based or stereotypical remarks.
3. Offensive	Habituated offensive comments that become behavioral patterns.
4. Highly Offensive	Intentional comments putting women down intellectually or physically.
5. Evident Sexual Offensive	Explicit crude behavior with complete disregard for consent.
6. Egregious Sexual Misconduct	Predatory behavior: assault, coercion, threats for sexual intimacy.

Organizational risk factors

These raise the risk of misconduct — but note: the presence of some risk factors does not necessarily translate into occurrences.

- Homogeneous workforce (e.g. skewed gender ratio, similar demographics).
- Non-conformists to workplace norms within the group.
- Demographic differences in language/culture/background not valued.
- Significant power hierarchies among employees.
- Monotonous, repetitive work creating tensions.
- Physical isolation of employees from each other.
- Decentralized management structures.
- Alcohol consumption or coarse social discourse outside the workplace.

Applied leadership contrast — Garry vs. Harry

Mr. Garry — commitment leadership	Mr. Harry — autonomy leadership
Leads by example, keeps promises, highly involved, continuously learns, builds trust and accountability. Creates high-performing teams because people follow commitment more than commands.	Encourages ownership, avoids micromanagement, gives autonomy, frees himself for strategy, builds confidence in experienced staff.
Risk: over-involvement, micromanaging if he doesn't delegate, burnout from solving everything himself.	Risk: reduced accountability, staff feel unsupported in crises, skills go stale without learning, deadlines/quality slip without monitoring.

The verdict (situational leadership in one line)

Be like Garry when the team needs guidance, coaching, and commitment. **Be like Harry** when the team is experienced and deserves autonomy.

Part B · The Master Mnemonic Glossary

Every acronym and framework in the course on one revisable spread. If you can reproduce this table from memory, you can answer any 'name the framework' question.

Mnemonic	Stands for	Use it for
SAPA	Situation analysis · Problem identification · (Decision) Analysis · Plan of action	Structured, objective case analysis. Evaluate, never judge.
IQ + EQ	Intellectual + Emotional Quotient	Every narrative needs both logic and human connection.
D-S-R-C	Directive · Spontaneous · Reflective · Cooperative	The 4 psychographic audience types.
POM	Presence of Mind	First of the 5 real-time narrator skills.
S-P-S-I	Situation · Problem · Solution · Input	The four-beat story 'Recipe' (Group 4).
O-C-E	Origin · Choices · Environment	The Story Blueprint's three building blocks.
3Es	Engagement · Essence · Energy	Capturing and holding an audience.
Aristotle 7	Theme · Plot · Character · Dialogue · Decor · Melody · Spectacle	The seven classical elements of storytelling.
FOTE / POTE	Fully / Partially Open Truthful Exchange	Degrees of transparency in trust-building.
TASK+S	Talent · Attitude · Skill · Knowledge (+ Style)	The 5 markers of Capability / Competence.
TRUST	Integrity · Intent · FOTE · Capability · Results	Building credibility and a counter-narrative (Group 7).
TWAB	Thoughts · Words · Actions · Behavior (in sync)	The test of Integrity.
SCARF	Status · Certainty · Autonomy · Relatedness · Fairness	Dr. David Rock's neuroscience of social threat/reward.
Gestalt 6	Proximity · Similarity · Closure · Continuity · Figure-Ground · Common Fate	Principles of visual perception for charts.
7 Data Structures	Change-over-time · Comparison · Ranking · Distribution · Part-to-whole · Correlation · Spatial	Choose the chart by the question it answers.
Skill × Will	Newbies · Superstars · P.P.P. · Shipwrecks	The four employee archetypes → Telling/Selling/Participating/Delegating.
8 Weaving Steps	Rule of 3 · Hook · Amplify · Engage · Intonation · Closure · Body language · No fillers	Crafting + delivering a story that lands (Group 8).
5 CEO Types	Charismatic · Thinker · Skeptic · Follower · Controller	Audience archetypes for persuading decision-makers.

Pyramid Principle	Recommendation → Reasons → Evidence	Top-down delivery: conclusion first.
SSMW	6-level spectrum: Not-offensive → Egregious	Grading workplace sexual misconduct (Group 7).

Part C · Worked Narrations

These are model answers that show the frameworks in motion. Use them as templates: swap in your own facts for a viva, or adapt the structure for a written 'craft a narrative' question. Each is annotated so you can see which technique is doing the work.

C1 · The 8 Weaving Steps in Action

> "Today, we stop borrowing from tomorrow. **[Hook — opens with tension]** I think about my daughter, who asked me last year why the sky near our old plant looked grey — and that question never left me. **[Amplify connection — a shared human experience]** Power, planet, and people: those are the three words that have guided every decision this year. **[Rule of 3 — alliterative triplet]** So let me ask you — what kind of company do we want to be in ten years? **[Superb engagement — rhetorical question]** **[pause]** Because here's what's true: we have signed contracts to power every facility with renewable energy by 2027. **[voice slows, drops in pitch]** This is the most important commitment I have made as CEO. **[Intonation modulation]** **[steady eye contact, open palms]** We are not just changing our energy source — we are changing what we stand for. **[Body language — open gestures]** And so, today, we don't just stop borrowing from tomorrow — we start building it. **[Closure — circles back to the hook]** Thank you." **[No fillers throughout]**

C2 · Persuading a 'Thinker' CEO (real applied example)

The obvious move was to compare prices and recommend the cheapest supplier. But for a Thinker, the real question is not 'Who is cheaper?' — it is 'Who creates the lowest total business risk?' So the narrator reframed the whole case:

- **Proposed a risk-adjusted supplier strategy** — allocate higher volume to the most reliable supplier while keeping a second approved supplier as backup.
- **Supplied the detail a Thinker demands** — lead time, material quality, defect incidents, past orders, track record.
- **Let the data lead** — did not force the conclusion; allowed the numbers to walk the CEO toward the recommendation.
- **Chose Thinker vocabulary** — proof, quality, risk mitigation, cost-benefit, reliability, long-term capability.

C3 · A Reusable Narration Skeleton (for any prompt)

When an exam says 'craft/deliver a narrative for X,' assemble it from parts you already know. This skeleton fuses the Narrative Arc, the Recipe, and the Weaving steps:

18. **Hook** (Weaving #2) — a one-line statement of tension or curiosity.
19. **To the point / Situation** — state the core message and set the scene objectively.
20. **Problem** — make the challenge felt, not just understood; amplify connection to the listener.
21. **Bit of Logic (Solution)** — your IQ: the data, the proof, the recommendation, structured Pyramid-style (conclusion first).
22. **Bit of Emotion** — your EQ: a Rule-of-3 line, a human example, a vivid image.
23. **Persuasion / Input** — the explicit ask or call to action.

24. **Closure** (Weaving #6) — circle back to the hook. Deliver with intonation, body language, and no fillers.

Adapt the skeleton to the audience

Directive/Thinker CEO → front-load steps 4 and 6 (logic, ask), compress the emotion. Spontaneous/Charismatic → lead with steps 1, 3, 5 (hook, connection, emotion). Reflective → expand step 4 with 5 W's + How. Cooperative → open by listening and asking a question before you present anything.

Part D · The Question Bank

120+ questions across four formats, graded easy → hard. Attempt them closed-book; the full answer key is in Part E. Section D1 (MCQ) and D2 (short-answer) drill recall; D3 (match) drills the glossary; D4 (application/case) is where the marks are on a real paper.

D1 · Multiple Choice (Q1–Q45)

Q1. A narrator is best described as a:

- **A)** Reporter of facts
- **B)** Navigator who guides the audience to meaning
- **C)** Neutral data source
- **D)** Slide operator

Q2. Narrative requires both IQ and:

- **A)** ROI
- **B)** EQ (Emotional Quotient)
- **C)** KPI
- **D)** IPO

Q3. Willy Loman in 'Death of a Salesman' illustrates:

- **A)** Great use of data
- **B)** Having facts but no narrative
- **C)** Excellent audience analysis
- **D)** The Pyramid Principle

Q4. A 'poker face' in your audience signals:

- **A)** Deep concentration
- **B)** Agreement
- **C)** Disengagement / not interested
- **D)** Respect

Q5. The three layers of audience analysis, from surface to deepest, are:

- **A)** Psychographics, Demographics, Socio-graphics
- **B)** Demographics, Socio-graphics, Psychographics
- **C)** Socio-graphics, Psychographics, Demographics
- **D)** Demographics, Psychographics, Firmographics

Q6. Which generation is described as purpose-driven and needing context?

- **A)** Gen X
- **B)** Millennials
- **C)** Gen Z
- **D)** Baby Boomers

Q7. A 'Directive' psychographic audience wants you to:

- **A)** Inspire with vision
- **B)** Quantify and prove — lead with the bottom line
- **C)** Build rapport first
- **D)** Show all your footnotes

Q8. The 'Reflective' audience type is best served by:

- **A)** Drama and analogies

B) The 5 W's + How and thorough prep
C) ROI on slide 1
D) Listening more than speaking

Q9. Which is NOT one of the 5 real-time narrator skills?

A) Presence of Mind
B) Spontaneity
C) Delegation
D) Mindfulness

Q10. The consultant who notices the CFO checking his watch and pivots immediately demonstrates:

A) Listening skills
B) Alert/Vigilant
C) Mindfulness
D) Spontaneity

Q11. The Pyramid Principle says you should start with:

A) The evidence
B) The conclusion / recommendation
C) A question
D) The backstory

Q12. 'Situation → Problem → Solution → Input' is the:

A) Narrative Arc
B) Story Template / Recipe
C) Pyramid Principle
D) SAPA framework

Q13. The Story Blueprint's three building blocks are:

A) Hook, Body, Close
B) Origin, Choices, Environment
C) Theme, Plot, Character
D) Plot, Arc, Structure

Q14. In the Group 4 toolkit, the component that 'decides how the audience feels' is the:

A) Plot
B) Arc
C) Structure
D) Storyboard

Q15. The Storyboard is used primarily to:

A) Deliver the story top-down
B) Mine personal material for story beats
C) Rate decision alternatives
D) Manage toxic employees

Q16. The Narrative Rule in SAPA states you must:

A) Insert opinion early
B) Stay entirely objective in the narrative phase
C) Always recommend the cheapest option
D) Judge each alternative

Q17. The two P's in SAPA stand for:

A) Problem and Plan
B) Process and People
C) Proof and Persuasion
D) Present and Past

Q18. An employee who is High Skill / Low Will is a:

A) Newbie
B) Superstar
C) Shipwreck
D) Pity Party Player

Q19. The correct leadership style for a 'Superstar' (High Skill/High Will) is:

A) Telling
B) Selling
C) Participating
D) Delegating

Q20. 'Telling' corresponds to which task/relationship mix?

A) High Task / Low Relationship
B) High Task / High Relationship
C) Low Task / High Relationship
D) Low Task / Low Relationship

Q21. The toxic-employee model is based on an HBR article by:

A) Clayton Christensen
B) Amy Gallo
C) David Rock
D) Daniel Goleman

Q22. The Golden Rule of the data-oriented feedback model is:

A) Always document everything
B) Never describe the person — only their actions and data
C) Isolate the employee first
D) Lead with emotion

Q23. Which is a Gestalt principle?

A) Ranking
B) Proximity
C) Correlation
D) Part-to-whole

Q24. 'The mind fills gaps to perceive a complete shape' describes:

A) Continuity
B) Closure
C) Similarity
D) Common Fate

Q25. To answer 'What components make up the total?' you use the ___ data structure:

A) Comparison
B) Distribution
C) Part-to-whole
D) Spatial

Q26. FOTE stands for:

- **A)** Fully Open Truthful Exchange
- **B)** Formal Open Team Evaluation
- **C)** Full Onboarding & Training Exercise
- **D)** Fair Objective Transparent Engagement

Q27. The 5 markers of Capability are Talent, Attitude, Skill, Knowledge and:

- **A)** Speed
- **B)** Style
- **C)** Stamina
- **D)** Status

Q28. The 3Es of storytelling are Engagement, Essence and:

- **A)** Empathy
- **B)** Energy
- **C)** Evidence
- **D)** Emotion

Q29. Engagement means capturing attention within the first:

- **A)** Minute
- **B)** Seven seconds
- **C)** Slide
- **D)** Thirty seconds

Q30. In Aristotle's seven elements, 'Spectacle' maps to which business application?

- **A)** Humanize the data
- **B)** Present surprising, attention-grabbing insights
- **C)** Focus on one message
- **D)** Understand the context

Q31. 'Melody' in Aristotle's framework represents:

- **A)** Logical flow
- **B)** Emotional rhythm/resonance
- **C)** The central idea
- **D)** Context and setting

Q32. The SCARF model was developed by:

- **A)** Amy Gallo
- **B)** Dr. David Rock
- **C)** Aristotle
- **D)** Simon Sinek

Q33. In SCARF, the ability to predict the future is:

- **A)** Status
- **B)** Certainty
- **C)** Autonomy
- **D)** Fairness

Q34. Letting a team choose its own sprint approach primarily boosts which SCARF domain?

- **A)** Status
- **B)** Certainty
- **C)** Autonomy

D) Relatedness

Q35. A CEO who responds to 'proven,' 'de-risked,' and 'track record' is a:

A) Charismatic
B) Thinker
C) Skeptic
D) Follower

Q36. A 'Controller' CEO needs, above all:

A) A bold vision
B) Granular control and accountability checkpoints
C) Social proof
D) Emotional appeal

Q37. 'Blood, toil, tears and sweat' (Churchill) is an example of the:

A) Hook
B) Rule of 3
C) Closure
D) Amplify connection

Q38. Circling back to your opening line at the end is the weaving step called:

A) Hook
B) Intonation
C) Closure
D) Body language

Q39. In the TRUST framework, 'TWAB in sync' defines:

A) Intent
B) Integrity
C) Capability
D) Results

Q40. 'TWAB' stands for:

A) Thoughts, Words, Actions, Behavior
B) Trust, Will, Ability, Belief
C) Talent, Work, Attitude, Beliefs
D) Task, Will, Action, Behaviour

Q41. On the Skill/Will grid, 'P.P.P.' stands for:

A) Proactive Performance Players
B) Pity Party Players
C) Peak Potential People
D) Process-Prioritising Personnel

Q42. In the PSU case, Rajshekhar's core leadership signature was:

A) Consensus-driven and humane
B) Results-driven, low tolerance for excuses
C) Disengaged messenger
D) Technically capable junior

Q43. The corporate parallel drawn to the PSU case was:

A) Enron
B) Wells Fargo's account-opening scandal

C) Theranos
D) Lehman Brothers

Q44. 'Authority enforces; leadership ___':

A) commands
B) aligns
C) delegates
D) dominates

Q45. The 'Figure of Four' refers to a posture fault in:

A) Gesturing
B) Sitting
C) Eye contact
D) Voice modulation

D2 · Short Answer (Q46–Q80)

Q46. State the GPS analogy for narrative in one sentence.

Q47. Name the two quotients every narrative needs and what each supplies.

Q48. List the three layers of audience analysis in order of depth.

Q49. How would you pitch a cost-saving initiative differently to a Gen X CFO versus a Millennial team?

Q50. Name the four psychographic audience types and give the one-word driver of each.

Q51. Which psychographic type is called 'the deepest layer' and why does it matter most?

Q52. List the five real-time narrator skills.

Q53. Distinguish 'listening skills' from 'alert/vigilant' with one example each.

Q54. State the Pyramid Principle in one line and say what a nervous presenter tends to do instead.

Q55. Write out the four beats of the Story 'Recipe.'

Q56. Name the three parts of the Story Blueprint.

Q57. Match the six Group-4 components to their one-word verbs (what/feel/organise/how/plan/deliver).

Q58. State the Narrative Rule that governs the narrative phase of a case analysis.

Q59. Expand SAPA and note the difference between 'evaluate' and 'judge.'

Q60. Name the four Skill/Will archetypes and the leadership style each needs.

Q61. Give the task/relationship mix for Telling, Selling, Participating and Delegating.

Q62. List the three steps of managing a toxic employee.

Q63. State the Golden Rule of the data-oriented feedback model.

Q64. Name all six Gestalt principles.

Q65. Match three business questions to the correct data structure (change / comparison / part-to-whole).

Q66. Differentiate FOTE from POTE.

Q67. List the five markers of Capability/Competence.

Q68. Name the 3Es and what each governs.

Q69. List Aristotle's seven elements of storytelling.

Q70. Give the business application of Decor, Melody and Spectacle.

Q71. Expand SCARF and attribute it to its author and institute.

Q72. For each SCARF domain, give a one-line workplace example.

Q73. Name the five CEO archetypes.

Q74. Give two buzzwords each for a Thinker and a Skeptic CEO.

Q75. List the eight steps of Narrative Weaving in order.

Q76. Explain the 'Rule of 3' and give one historical example.

Q77. Expand the TRUST framework's five components.

Q78. What does TWAB stand for and which TRUST component does it test?

Q79. State the two-line verdict contrasting 'Garry' and 'Harry' leadership.

Q80. Give three of the five executive takeaways from the PSU leadership case.

D3 · Match the Framework (Q81–Q95)

Match each scenario/description in the left column to the correct framework or term. Answers in Part E.

Q	Scenario / description	Your answer
81	A manager grounds a difficult feedback conversation only in documented behaviours, never the person's character.	
82	You start your recommendation with the conclusion, then layer reasons and evidence beneath it.	
83	A leader ensures her Thoughts, Words, Actions and Behavior are all aligned.	
84	You choose a chart because the question is 'who is first and who is last?'	
85	A speaker opens with 'Today, Apple reinvents the phone.'	
86	An employee is highly skilled but has lost all motivation.	
87	A CEO responds to 'legacy,' 'bet big,' and a bold future state.	
88	You protect a team member's sense of control by letting them pick their own approach.	
89	Complete transparency with nothing withheld in an exchange.	
90	You map your childhood, B.E., MBA and family against themes to find story material.	
91	Aligned elements on a line are perceived as related.	
92	Capturing attention within the first seven seconds.	
93	A senior's protective behaviour crosses into intrusion, violating a boundary.	
94	Splitting problems into long-term (trust deficit) and short-term (bypass of authority).	
95	Varying pitch and pace to mark your most important line.	

D4 · Application & Case Questions (Q96–Q125)

These carry the marks on a real paper. Aim for structured answers that name a framework, apply it to specifics, and state a recommendation. Model answers in Part E.

Q96. You must present a 3-year cost-reduction plan to a board with one Directive CFO and two Spontaneous founders. Describe how you would structure the SAME deck to hold both — sequence, opening, and where the data goes.

Q97. A star performer on your team (High Skill) has become cynical and disengaged (Low Will) after being passed over for promotion. Diagnose her on the Skill/Will grid and prescribe the specific leadership style and two concrete actions, using SCARF to explain the disengagement.

Q98. Using the 8 Narrative Weaving steps, write a 150-word CEO announcement introducing a company-wide four-day work week. Annotate at least five steps in brackets.

Q99. A colleague is consistently late to deliverables and dismissive in meetings. Using Amy Gallo's three-step process and the data-oriented feedback model, script the opening two minutes of your feedback conversation. Respect the Golden Rule.

Q100. Apply SAPA to the PSU case (Rajshekhar/Bala): give one line for Situation, split Problems into long- and short-term, list three decision alternatives, and recommend a Plan of Action.

Q101. You are pitching an AI product to Elon Musk (a Skeptic archetype) and, separately, to Herb Kelleher (a Charismatic). Give the opening line and the core persuasion move for each.

Q102. Choose the correct data structure and justify it for: (a) regional sales across 12 states, (b) revenue trend over 5 years, (c) market share split among 4 competitors, (d) relationship between ad spend and sales.

Q103. Using the TRUST framework, explain how a new manager with no track record can still build trust with a skeptical team in her first month. Address at least four of the five components.

Q104. Rewrite this weak opener into a strong Hook + Amplify-connection opening: 'Today I will present our Q3 logistics performance metrics and some proposed improvements.'

Q105. A community consultation for a CSR project keeps stalling because residents feel unheard. Identify the psychographic audience type, name the two SCARF domains most under threat, and give three specific facilitation moves.

Q106. Map the Garry-vs-Harry contrast onto the Skill/Will grid: for which archetype is each leader ideal, and what is the failure mode when the match is wrong?

Q107. Using the Pyramid Principle, restructure a rambling recommendation ('We looked at vendors A, B, C; A is cheap but slow; B is fast but pricey; C is mid; overall we think B…') into a clean top-down three-tier answer.

Q108. Explain, with the Wells Fargo parallel, why 'informal workarounds are operational debt.' What is the single structural fix the PSU case recommends?

Q109. You have a Reflective policy committee and only 10 minutes. Given executive-presence guidance for sub-15-minute talks, describe your delivery choices (slides, posture, anchoring) and how you compress a detail-hungry audience's needs.

Q110. Design a 5-slide data story answering 'why should we enter the Tier-2 city market?' Assign each slide one of the 7 data structures and name the single core message (Essence).

Q111. A team member from a different linguistic/cultural background is being subtly excluded, and the workforce is highly homogeneous. Identify three organizational risk factors present and propose two trust-and-confidence measures.

Q112. Convert the 'renewable energy' worked narration (C1) into a version tuned for a Thinker CEO audience: what do you cut, what do you add, and why?

Q113. Give a boundary-analysis of the Juhi & Reddy case using the SSMW spectrum: at which level does Reddy's conduct sit, why do intentions not exempt it, and what does 'respect boundaries' prescribe going forward?

Q114. You are a Cooperative-type stakeholder's least favourite kind of presenter: fast and slide-driven. Rewrite your approach for the first five minutes to earn trust before presenting any data.

Q115. Using IQ+EQ, critique a purely data-dense investor deck that 'has all the facts.' What is the Willy Loman risk, and what two EQ elements would you inject?

Q116. Apply the 3Es to a product demo that is technically flawless but consistently loses the room by minute three. Diagnose which E is failing and give a fix for each.

Q117. A Charismatic CEO wants to 'bet big' on an unproven market; your data says pilot first. Craft a narrative that respects his archetype while steering him toward the Skeptic's discipline. Give the hook and the pivot.

Q118. Build a personal 'Who are you?' narrative for a PM interview using the Storyboard + Blueprint + Recipe. Give the beats, not the full script.

Q119. Explain how Gestalt 'proximity' and 'similarity' can be misused to create a misleading chart, and how the Clarity/Focus/Context principle guards against it.

Q120. Synthesise: pick any THREE frameworks from this course and show how they combine to handle a single high-stakes board presentation end to end (audience read → build → deliver).

Q121. SCARF: You must deliver bad news — a project's budget has been cut 30%. For each of the five SCARF domains, name the threat you must reduce and give one concrete line that turns it into a reward rather than a threat.

Q122. SCARF: Rewrite each of these 'threat' openers into a 'reward' version and name the domain it protects: (a) 'Let me explain this, it's complicated'; (b) 'You should just implement Option A'; (c) 'This new strategy will boost revenue by 20%' (stated with no downside).

Q123. SCARF vs. Certainty trap: A presenter opens a 30-minute strategy review by diving straight into a detailed cost model with no signposting. Which SCARF domain is being violated, what is the audience's likely internal reaction, and what one sentence fixes it?

Q124. SCARF + Autonomy: Your data clearly points to one best option, yet the room is senior and territorial. Explain how to honour Autonomy without abdicating your recommendation — give the exact framing you'd use.

Q125. SCARF + Fairness applied to credibility: Explain why acknowledging a trade-off ('this improves speed but raises upfront cost') makes you MORE persuasive, not less, and link this to why a one-sided pitch triggers a threat response.

Part E · Answer Key & Exam Strategy

E1 · MCQ Answers (Q1–Q45)

Q1: **B**	Q2: **B**	Q3: **B**	Q4: **C**	Q5: **B**
Q6: **B**	Q7: **B**	Q8: **B**	Q9: **C**	Q10: **B**
Q11: **B**	Q12: **B**	Q13: **B**	Q14: **B**	Q15: **B**
Q16: **B**	Q17: **A**	Q18: **C**	Q19: **D**	Q20: **A**
Q21: **B**	Q22: **B**	Q23: **B**	Q24: **B**	Q25: **C**
Q26: **A**	Q27: **B**	Q28: **B**	Q29: **B**	Q30: **B**
Q31: **B**	Q32: **B**	Q33: **C**	Q34: **C**	Q35: **B**
Q36: **B**	Q37: **C**	Q38: **B**	Q39: **A**	Q40: **B**
Q41: **B**	Q42: **B**	Q43: **B**	Q44: **B**	

E2 · Short-Answer Model Answers (Q46–Q80)

Q46. A narrative is the GPS for your data — it doesn't just list the roads (facts), it tells the audience where to turn and why.

Q47. IQ (logic, data, evidence, structure) and EQ (empathy, tone, human connection). Both are required — one without the other fails.

Q48. Demographics (surface) → Socio-graphics (region/culture) → Psychographics (personality/decision style, deepest).

Q49. Gen X CFO: lead with the numbers. Millennial team: start with 'why it matters' before the numbers.

Q50. Directive (prove), Spontaneous (inspire), Reflective (research/homework), Cooperative (trust/rapport).

Q51. Psychographics — because it dictates the actual narrative style; two people with identical demographics can need opposite approaches.

Q52. Presence of Mind, Spontaneity, Alert/Vigilant, Listening Skills, Mindfulness.

Q53. Listening = active data collection that shapes your next move (70/30 in discovery). Alert/Vigilant = reading the room's non-verbals and adjusting before disengagement (the watch-checking CFO).

Q54. Start with the conclusion, then layer reasoning and evidence. A nervous presenter does the reverse — building up to the conclusion last.

Q55. Situation → Problem → Solution → Input (a clear ask for the audience).

Q56. Origin, Choices, Environment.

Q57. Plot = what, Arc = feel, Template = organise, Structure = how, Storyboard = plan, Pyramid Principle = deliver.

Q58. Stay entirely objective in the narrative phase — never insert personal opinion; you evaluate, never judge.

Q59. Situation analysis → Problem identification → (Decision) Analysis → Plan of action. 'Evaluate' weighs pros/cons neutrally; 'judge' imposes a verdict prematurely.

Q60. Newbies → Telling? No — Newbies (Low Skill/High Will) → High Task/High Relationship (Selling). Superstars → Delegating. P.P.P. → Telling. Shipwrecks → Participating (High Relationship/Low Task).

Q61. Telling = High Task/Low Rel; Selling = High Task/High Rel; Participating = High Rel/Low Task; Delegating = Low Rel/Low Task.

Q62. Communication (understand root causes, transparent feedback) → Action (state impact, document) → Task Orientation (isolate if needed, focus on output).

Q63. Never describe the person — only their actions and data.

Q64. Proximity, Similarity, Closure, Continuity, Figure-Ground, Common Fate.

Q65. Change over time → 'what changed?'; Comparison → 'who/what is better?'; Part-to-whole → 'what makes up the total?'

Q66. FOTE = Fully Open Truthful Exchange (nothing withheld). POTE = Partially Open Truthful Exchange (selective disclosure, still honest).

Q67. Talent, Attitude, Skill, Knowledge, Style.

Q68. Engagement (capture attention in 7 seconds), Essence (one clear message), Energy (delivery — eye contact, voice, body language).

Q69. Theme, Plot, Character, Dialogue, Decor, Melody, Spectacle.

Q70. Decor → understand audience/context; Melody → build emotional resonance; Spectacle → present surprising, attention-grabbing insights.

Q71. Status, Certainty, Autonomy, Relatedness, Fairness — Dr. David Rock, NeuroLeadership Institute.

Q72. Status: public credit/titles. Certainty: clear roadmaps. Autonomy: team picks its sprint. Relatedness: onboarding buddies. Fairness: transparent pay bands.

Q73. Charismatic, Thinker, Skeptic, Follower, Controller.

Q74. Thinker: 'ROI,' 'data shows,' 'benchmark,' 'efficiency.' Skeptic: 'proven,' 'de-risked,' 'validated,' 'track record.'

Q75. Rule of 3, Hook, Amplify connection, Superb engagement, Intonation modulation, Closure, Body language, No fillers.

Q76. Repeat three words sharing the same initial sound for rhythm and recall. Example: 'Blood, toil, tears and sweat' (Churchill) or MLK's 'let freedom ring.'

Q77. Integrity, Intent, FOTE (Full Open Truthful Exchange), Capability, Results.

Q78. Thoughts, Words, Actions, Behavior — it tests Integrity (all four in sync).

Q79. Be like Garry when the team needs guidance, coaching and commitment; be like Harry when the team is experienced and deserves autonomy.

Q80. Any three of: authority enforces/leadership aligns; build accountability into roles not relationships; separate performance from disciplinary action; treat transfers as change events needing a transition plan; presence is a credibility multiplier.

> **Note on Q60**
>
> Watch the trap: the archetype→style mapping is often mis-stated. Newbies need **Selling** (High Task/High Rel), Shipwrecks need **Participating** (High Rel/Low Task), P.P.P. need **Telling**, Superstars need **Delegating.**

E3 · Match-the-Framework Answers (Q81–Q95)

Q81. Data-Oriented Feedback Model — the Golden Rule (actions & data, not the person).

Q82. Pyramid Principle.

Q83. Integrity / TWAB in sync (TRUST framework).

Q84. Ranking (one of the 7 data structures).

Q85. Hook statement (Narrative Weaving step 2).

Q86. Shipwreck (High Skill / Low Will) → needs Participating.

Q87. Charismatic CEO archetype.

Q88. Autonomy (SCARF).

Q89. FOTE — Fully/Full Open Truthful Exchange.

Q90. The Storyboard (mining personal material).

Q91. Continuity (Gestalt).

Q92. Engagement (the first of the 3Es).

Q93. Juhi & Reddy boundary case — 'Respect Boundaries: protective behaviour can become intrusive.'

Q94. Problem Identification in SAPA (long-term vs short-term).

Q95. Intonation modulation (Narrative Weaving step 5).

E4 · Application & Case — Model Answer Outlines (Q96–Q125)

These are marking-scheme outlines: the structure and the must-hit points. In an exam, expand each into prose but keep the named frameworks visible — that is what earns marks.

Q96. Open with a Spontaneous-friendly hook/vision (30 sec) to hold the founders; immediately state the core recommendation (Pyramid — conclusion first) for the Directive CFO; put the hard ROI/data in the middle tier where the CFO lives; use one vivid analogy (EQ) per section for the founders; close with a single clear ask. The deck order serves the Directive; the framing/energy serves the Spontaneous.

Q97. Grid: High Skill / Low Will = Shipwreck → Participating (High Relationship / Low Task). SCARF diagnosis: the missed promotion hit Status (and likely Fairness) → disengagement. Actions: (1) a one-on-one that restores Status (visible ownership of a high-value project, public credit) and (2) restore Fairness/Certainty by making the next promotion criteria explicit. Do NOT pile on Task — that worsens a Shipwreck.

Q98. Must contain an annotated Hook, Rule-of-3 line, Amplify-connection (human/shared experience), a rhetorical question (engagement), a pitch/pace shift (intonation), and a Closure that circles back to the hook — delivered with no fillers. Marks for correct labelling, not prose polish.

Q99. Step 1 Communication: open by naming specific documented behaviours ('in the last three sprints, deliverables X, Y, Z were late by N days; in Tuesday's review, comment A was made') — never 'you're unreliable/dismissive.' State the team/business impact (Action step). Keep it to actions + data (Golden Rule). Then invite root-cause dialogue.

Q100. S: Bala disengaged; Naresh informally covered via Ilengo; simultaneous transfers exposed the gap; Rajshekhar's punitive correction escalated it. Problems — long-term: trust deficit + embedded inefficiency; short-term: bypass of authority + no transition plan. Alternatives: (a) phased transfer with handover, (b) formal performance plan for Bala, (c) build capability into the role. Plan: separate performance from discipline, install a transition plan, build accountability into the role not the relationship.

Q101. Musk (Skeptic): open with proof — 'Here's the pilot data and third-party validation'; move = address the biggest objection first, lead with de-risking and track record. Kelleher (Charismatic): open with a bold future — 'This is how we reinvent the category'; move = appeal to vision, legacy and emotion before the numbers.

Q102. (a) Spatial; (b) Change over time; (c) Part-to-whole; (d) Correlation. One-line justification each tied to the question the structure answers.

Q103. Hit ≥4 of: Integrity (TWAB in sync — consistent word and action from day one), Intent (declare her agenda openly), FOTE (transparent communication), Capability (demonstrate Talent/Attitude/Skill/Knowledge via early wins), Results (she can't show past track record, so she leans on present performance + a credible future plan).

Q104. Weak opener is a flat agenda. Strong: Hook ('Last quarter, one delayed truck cost us a customer we'd had for nine years.') + Amplify connection ('Every person here has felt that call.') then transition to the data. Marks for a genuine tension-hook and a shared-experience tie.

Q105. Type: Cooperative. SCARF domains most under threat: Relatedness and Fairness (also Status/Voice). Moves: listen first and reflect back what you heard, ask questions before presenting, show humility and co-create the agenda; only then present data.

Q106. Garry (commitment/coaching) is ideal for Newbies and Shipwrecks (need guidance/re-engagement); failure mode = micromanaging Superstars → burnout + lost autonomy. Harry (autonomy) is ideal for Superstars (High Skill/High Will); failure mode = abandoning Newbies/P.P.P. who read autonomy as indifference → accountability collapse.

Q107. Top tier (Recommendation): 'Choose Vendor B.' Middle (Reasons): speed meets our launch deadline; total cost of delay < price premium; acceptable risk. Base (Evidence): the A/B/C lead-time and cost figures. Conclusion first, support beneath — no meandering.

Q108. Informal workarounds (Naresh→Ilengo) substitute a person for a process, so the capability never enters the role — like debt, it accrues 'interest' until a shock (the simultaneous transfers) forces repayment all at once. Structural fix: build accountability into the role, with a transition plan — not into a relationship. Wells Fargo shows the same debt compounding until external escalation.

Q109. Reflective + <15-min talk. Delivery: minimal slides, let the speaker anchor attention (hold position, don't hide behind slides), composed posture, full-room eye contact, controlled voice. Compress by pre-answering the 5 W's + How in a tight handout/appendix so the detail-hungry committee is satisfied without blowing the clock.

Q110. Essence (one message) e.g. 'Tier-2 is our fastest-payback growth lever.' Slides: (1) Change-over-time — our growth plateau; (2) Comparison — Tier-1 vs Tier-2 CAC/ROI; (3) Part-to-whole — untapped share; (4) Ranking — top candidate cities; (5) Spatial — geographic rollout. Each slide = one structure answering one question.

Q111. Risk factors present (any 3): homogeneous workforce; demographic/cultural differences not valued; possibly non-conformist grouping or isolation. Measures (any 2): diversity & inclusion; clear performance expectations; formal communication; clear accountability; confidence & engagement.

Q112. For a Thinker: cut some of the emotional/daughter framing to a single line; add the signed-contract data, cost/benefit, and risk-mitigation numbers up front (Pyramid); keep the Rule-of-3 for recall but let data lead the conclusion. Rationale: a Thinker is persuaded by evidence, not emotion.

Q113. On SSMW, Reddy's intrusive-but-'protective' overstep sits low-to-mid on the spectrum but is still a boundary violation; intentions don't exempt it because impact (Juhi's distress, the boundary crossed) governs, and a senior is held to a higher duty of care. 'Respect boundaries' prescribes maintaining professional distance and reading discomfort signals regardless of intent.

Q114. Reframe as Cooperative-first: spend the first five minutes listening and asking (What outcome matters to you? What worries you?), reflect their answers back, show humility, establish shared ground — defer all slides/data until trust is visible. IQ matters less than cooperation for this audience.

Q115. Willy Loman risk: all facts, no narrative → a poker-faced, disengaged audience. Inject EQ via (1) a Character/human moment that humanises the numbers and (2) Melody/emotional resonance (a story or vivid example) plus a clear Theme so one message survives.

Q116. The failing E is usually Essence (too much, no single idea) compounding into lost Energy by minute three. Fix: cut to one core message (Essence); re-hook attention with a question/prop (Engagement); raise delivery Energy — pace change, eye contact, a demo beat that lands.

Q117. Respect the Charismatic hook ('This could be the bet that defines us') then pivot with a de-risking bridge borrowed from the Skeptic's playbook: 'The boldest version of this bet is the one we can prove first — a 90-day pilot that lets us go all-in with evidence.' Vision preserved, discipline inserted.

Q118. Storyboard to mine a real beat (a project failure/turnaround); Blueprint: Origin (where you started), Choices (the pivotal decision), Environment (constraints); Recipe: Situation → Problem → Solution → Input (what you now bring to this PM role). Give the beats, deliver top-down (Pyramid) in the actual answer.

Q119. Proximity/similarity can falsely group unrelated data (e.g. spacing or colouring dissimilar categories to look like one trend). Clarity/Focus/Context guards against it: give the chart a distinct context, a dedicated visual space and proper closure so the grouping can't be misread.

Q120. Any coherent trio, e.g.: (1) Audience read — Psychographics + CEO archetype to profile the board; (2) Build — SAPA/Recipe + Pyramid to structure the recommendation; (3) Deliver — 8 Weaving steps + Executive Presence + SCARF to land it without triggering defensiveness. Marks for showing the hand-offs between the three.

Q121. Status — threat: team feels blamed/diminished; reward: 'Your work is exactly why we're protecting this — let's decide together where the 30% comes from.' Certainty — threat: fear of the unknown; reward: 'Here's precisely what changes and what doesn't over the next quarter.' Autonomy — threat: change feels imposed; reward: 'You choose which scope we trim — I'll show the impact of each option.' Relatedness — threat: us-vs-management; reward: 'I've argued this budget too; we're on the same side here.' Fairness — threat: sense the cut is arbitrary; reward: 'Here's the transparent rationale and how every team was treated the same way.' Full marks require the threat/reward pairing, not just the definitions.

Q122. (a) Status: 'Given your background you already know the broader challenge — let me focus on the part that matters most.' (b) Autonomy: 'Here are three alternatives; based on your objectives, Option A gives the best balance.' (c) Fairness: 'This should lift revenue ~20%, though it raises upfront cost and first-quarter complexity.' Each rewrite must name its domain.

Q123. Domain violated: Certainty. Likely reaction: anxiety/disengagement — the audience doesn't know where the talk is going and stops following. Fix (one sentence roadmap): 'In the next ten minutes I'll cover the problem, the recommendation, and the implementation plan.' Signposting removes the threat and lets them follow the narrative.

Q124. Honour Autonomy by presenting the choice architecture, not abdicating the call: lay out the real options with trade-offs, then state your recommendation as a reasoned default the room can own — 'We evaluated three paths; based on your stated priorities, Option B is strongest, but I've shown the trade-offs so the decision stays yours.' You keep a clear recommendation (Autonomy for you), they keep ownership (Autonomy for them).

Q125. Acknowledging a trade-off raises Fairness-perceived credibility: a balanced case signals you've considered multiple perspectives and aren't selling, so the audience lowers its guard. A one-sided pitch triggers a Fairness threat — the brain registers 'I'm being manipulated,' raises scepticism, and discounts even the true claims. Balance is therefore more persuasive precisely because it reduces the threat response.

E5 · Exam Strategy — How to Attack Each Question Type

For MCQs & 'name the framework'

- Reproduce Part B from memory first — most objective marks come straight off the glossary.
- Watch the two classic traps: **(a) the Skill/Will → style mapping** (Newbies=Selling, Shipwrecks=Participating, not the intuitive pairing), and **(b) attributing SCARF/SAPA/Amy Gallo correctly** — David Rock (SCARF), Amy Gallo (toxic employee), Aristotle (7 elements).

For short-answer

- Lead with the named framework, then the expansion. 'The Pyramid Principle: start with the conclusion, then layer reasons and evidence.' Name + one line is usually full marks.
- Don't editorialise on case-analysis questions — the Narrative Rule (stay objective) is itself examinable and graders notice opinion creeping in.

For application & case

25. **Name the framework** explicitly (SAPA, SCARF, Skill/Will, Pyramid, the 8 steps).
26. **Apply it to the specifics** in the prompt — quote the character, the number, the archetype.
27. **End with a recommendation** or clear 'input/ask.' A case answer with no decision loses the top band.
28. **If it's a 'craft a narrative' prompt**, use the C3 skeleton and annotate the techniques in brackets — visible labelling earns the marks.

> **The one sentence to carry into the hall**
>
> ***Read the audience, build it objectively, deliver it top-down with presence — and always name the framework you're using.***

End of Companion

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